

AGENT FLEET · FIELD NOTES

OpenAI just launched agents that work while you sleep

I have been running that for months.
On a Raspberry Pi. On my desk.

THE PROMISE IS REAL

My fleet runs jobs at 3am

It transcribes, it scans, it files things.
It does that whether I am awake or not.

That part works exactly as advertised.

THE PART NOBODY DEMOS

Then something broke at 3am

One agent filtered messages by its own name.
Nothing matched. It went quiet for **nine hours**.

No error. No alert. Nothing in the log said broken.

I found out at breakfast.

THE FAILURE MODE

**An agent that
stopped
looks identical to
an
agent with
nothing to do**

Silence and success are the same signal.

That is the whole problem, and it is why
unattended agents fail quietly instead of loudly.

WHAT I CHANGED

Three rules for unattended agents

- Every job reports that it ran, not just that it finished
- Silence is treated as failure, not as success
- Nothing writes without a heartbeat I can check

THE SHORT VERSION

**Autonomy is easy
to launch.
Supervision is
the product.**

FIELD NOTES FROM RUNNING AGENTS

The tools are now good enough that this matters more than the model does.